

■ 1.2.5 The Four Kinds of Bracketing in *Mathematica*

We have now introduced all the four kinds of bracketing used in *Mathematica*. Each kind of bracketing has a very different meaning. It is important that you remember all of them.

$(term)$	parentheses for grouping
$f[x]$	square brackets for functions
$\{a, b, c\}$	curly brackets (braces) for lists
$v[[i]]$	double brackets for indexing

The four kinds of bracketing in *Mathematica*.

When the expressions you type in are complicated, it is often a good idea to put extra space inside each set of brackets. This makes it somewhat easier for you to see matching pairs of brackets. $v[[\{a, b\}]]$ is, for example, easier to recognize than $v[[\{a, b\}]]$.